Weekly Progress Report

RAG Evaluation · 26–31 October 2026

ON TRACK Week scope complete. Hybrid re-run and half-true / telco experiments finished. Merge to main is pending.

48/54	89%	0%	3
JUDGE AGREEMENT qwen3:8b · 54 labels · ≥ 0.5	SHOP SECTION HIT Hybrid bge-m3 · was 82%	SHOP OFF-TOPIC Want low · was 17% keyword	TENANTS SCORED shop · noon · telco hybrid

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

- Built a DeepEval RAG eval next to existing retrieval tests: passage relevancy and reply faithfulness, gold as policy section IDs, judges local Ollama or Groq only.
- Trusted judge is local qwen3:8b at 48/54 (89%) on 54 hand labels. Quote 48/54, not the earlier 30/30. Groq 43/54; 4b 46/54. Live quoted replies at 91% are inflated.
- Hybrid bge-m3 re-run is done: shop 89% / off-topic 0%; noon 98%; telco 82% but off-topic still ~44% and no-answer recall fell 58% → 33%.
- Tried stricter faithfulness and a telco score floor; both hurt held-out quality and were not shipped.

KEY ACCOMPLISHMENTS

- CLI python -m team_a eval-rag (section hit, abstention, relevancy, faithfulness) plus 8 unit tests.
- 54-row faithfulness exam: original 30 untouched, 24 appended (wrong number, wrong section, invented extra, half-true). Hand-reviewed; all labels kept.
- Judge bake-off, Arabizi→Arabic script (17/22 → 18/22, not a fix), RAGAS-prompt fallback 47/54 with 2 false alarms.
- Pulled bge-m3, rebuilt shop / noon / telco indexes, re-scored hybrid relevancy on the test splits.

MILESTONES THIS WEEK

- Framework selected: DeepEval default; RAGAS fallback; TruLens / Phoenix / promptfoo deferred.
- Work is on branch cursor/deepeval-rag-eval (pushed). Pull request into main is not open yet.

LOCKED DECISIONS

01 Trusted judge is local qwen3:8b. Not Groq, not 4b.

02 Quote 48/54 at ≥ 0.5. Do not quote the earlier 30/30.

03 Hybrid bge-m3 is how relevancy is scored from now on.

04 Telco off-topic is retrieval / corpus, not a DeepEval bug.

05 91% live-quote faithfulness is not “the bot is grounded.” Use the 54 labels.

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PROGRESS BY WORKSTREAM

TASK / WORKSTREAM	STATUS	PROGRESS	KEY UPDATE
DeepEval harness + CLI	Completed	Done	eval-rag next to eval-retrieval; does not replace recall@5
54-row faithfulness labels	Completed	54/54	30 original + 24 new; hand-reviewed; all kept
Judge comparison	Completed	48/54	qwen3:8b 89%; Groq 80%; 4b 85%; 0 false alarms at ≥ 0.5
Hybrid relevancy (bge-m3)	Completed	3/3	Shop 89% / 0% off-topic; noon 98%; telco 82% / 44%
Half-true scoring experiment	Completed	Tried	Any-claim-fails: 41/54. Keep ≥ 0.5; strict score is diagnostic only
Telco confidence floor	Completed	Tried	0.50 helped dev; test Arabizi 19/30 → 15/30. Not shipped
PR into main	Pending	Not started	Branch pushed; pull request not opened
Telco off-topic product rule	Pending	Open	Jobs / 5G / TV / insurance still retrieve; needs when-to-return-empty
Conversation citation 70.7% vs 95%	Pending	Open	Agent not quoting; retrieval already high. Team B / prompt

RELEVANCY — KEYWORD VS HYBRID

TENANT	SECTION HIT	OFF-TOPIC STILL RELEVANT	NOTE
shop_001	82% → 89%	17% → 0%	Clean win on hybrid
noon_eg	90% → 98%	14% → 18%	Recall up; off-topic slightly worse
telco_001	77% → 82%	46% → 44%	No-answer recall 58% → 33%

TRIED AND NOT SHIPPED

- Arabizi to Arabic script: 17/22 → 18/22. Optional preprocess, not a fix.
- RAGAS as default: stricter on Arabizi errors, 2 false alarms on good paraphrases. Fallback only.
- Faithfulness “any unsupported claim fails”: 48/54 → 41/54. Judge reads “14 days” as “1:4”. Rows scored 1.00 still slip.
- Telco min_top_score 0.50: better abstention on dev; worse Arabizi on held-out test. Floor not shipped.

NEXT WEEK · MANAGEMENT ASKS

- If merged: open the PR; telco product rule (when to return empty — not another judge); optional CI for deterministic eval-rag only.
- Conversation citation 70.7% vs 95% stays outside this RAG-eval track unless management assigns it.

SUNDAY DECISION PACK

1. Merge cursor/deepeval-rag-eval into main?
2. Who owns telco “return empty on off-topic”?
3. Is conversation citation 70.7% vs 95% this track?